

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 253

Culture (OWC): [Kaffa \(MP14\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1926

Coverage Date: 1897-1932

Place Coverage: Kaffa, Ethiopia

Section Title(S): CAMP IN BONKA.

I found to-day a number of small huts concealed in the depths of the bush. They were of a very primitive nature and consisted of posts stuck in the ground with a pointed roof laid upon them. Small groves of enset bananas and coffee surrounded them. There was no trace of men or animals. Nevertheless the still-smouldering fires proved that the huts had only recently been vacated—in all probability at the news of my approach. According to Chinito, who had accompanied me, this was a village belonging to the aboriginal inhabitants of Kafa—the Mancho—and I therefore determined to await their return. Meanwhile I dispatched Chinito and several of my boys to look for the fugitives. After a time they made their appearance with fear in their eyes. A few odds and ends—safetypins, matches, etc.—which I gave them helped to win their confidence and I was finally able to inspect their huts. The household utensils were of the simplest, and an earthenware jug (gondo), used for making coffee, seemed to be the most precious possession of the first coffee-drinkers known to the world. Two sick men have promised to come to the camp to-morrow to be given medicine. Chinito and my boys took the greatest care not to come into contact with the Mancho in order not to become 'unclean.' In no circumstances would they enter the huts, and later they made jokes among themselves about men who build their huts in [254](#) a lonely place in the bush. It was clear that they had little sympathy or comprehension of the agony of a dying race that has been persecuted for centuries.

[126
Recording And
Collecting In The Field](#)
[186
Cultural Identity And
Pride](#)
[361
Settlement Patterns](#)
[415
Utensils](#)

Human Relations Area Files

*755 Prospect Street**New Haven, CT 06511*General Inquiries: [✉ hraf@yale.edu](mailto:hraf@yale.edu)Issues and Bugs: [✉ hraf-support@yale.edu](mailto:hraf-support@yale.edu)

[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)